me the editor altho without any increase of pay or allowances as yet. (Our first number appeared on the 5th Feby and I received your letter on the 18th.)

You ask about my income and manner of life. My pay is four hundred tomauns a year (say about a hundred and eighty pounds) and I have an allowance for forage for my horses and house-rent. Soon after we arrived I was long in arrears now those arrears are paid up, except what was due to me before this king came to the throne which however I hope to get shortly. My employment is making out translations of the European news for the king and prime minister — these are about forty pages of Persian a month which is about equal to forty pages of English print the same size as a leading article in the papers and the pages are small quarto. Besides this I have to attend levees and other work and now I have the whole management of this newspaper on my shoulders.[125] So you see I have work enough. My friends are chiefly the officers of the British and Russian missions with many of whom I am on intimate terms. For the first week or two after the paper was started I was so harrassed that I did not know which way to turn, and one evening after I had been dining at Col Shiel's (our minister here) I went to Mr R. Thomson's the third attaché, and there [were] three or four of us there, and I thought we were to have a pleasant hour or two over our grog and songs, all free and easy, when Meerza Hussein Kouli the Persian secretary to the mission began criticising a passage in one of the articles in the gazette, upon a question of style. (In this however, I afterwards proved him wrong.) This rather annoyed me and as I had been hard at work at the paper all day I wished to hear no more about it, one of my friends perceiving this said "Why Burgess is vexed." I said, "I was but it has passed off in proof of which I will sing you a song" and I sang "Gaffer Gray Gaffer's son and their little jackass" which I dare say you recollect for our poor Mother used to sing it to us when we were children. Perhaps you may not recollect it for when you had attained an age to remember such things, misfortunes had come upon our family and our poor mother had not much spirits for singing. It is an old and very rare song with perhaps no great merit in it, but there is a verse in it peculiarly applicable to my being bothered by people from morning 'til night about the newspaper. I never heard any one sing it except our dear Mother.

Col and Mrs Shiel are both exceedingly kind to me, the lady plays the piano and sings prettily and when the Russians dine there we have some good music. They are all more or less musical and the greatest treat I have had was hearing

125 Cf. Robert B. M. Binning, *Journal of two years travel in Persia, etc.*, London, 1857, v. 2, p. 215, discussing the scarcity of Europeans in Teheran, "...but excepting two or three French and Italian shopkeepers, and one Englishman, who acts as translator to the Shah, and manages the only newspaper..." This was the first newspaper printed in Persia; its name was *Rusnama-i-waqayi'-i-ittifaqiyya* ("Journal of occasional happenings"), cf. E. G. Browne, *The Persian press and Persian journalism*, London, 1914, p. 8.

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